Aion-IA : Quantum Computing Challenge

Terms and Conditions

1. Introduction & Overview

Welcome to the **Aion-IA Quantum Computing Challenge**! This competition aims to drive groundbreaking advancements in quantum computing by encouraging innovators, researchers, and developers to solve real-world challenges using quantum technologies. The competition is hosted by **Aion-IA Quantum Research Company**, backed by **Apeiria Enterprise Pvt Ltd**, which serves as the official corporate partner to facilitate investments and commercialization of innovative solutions.

By participating, all applicants agree to the following terms and conditions.

2. Competition Structure

The challenge follows a structured multi-phase approach:

• **April 1, 2025:** Official launch – registrations open

• **May 31, 2025:** Registration closes

• **August 15, 2025:** Final idea submission deadline

• **September 15, 2025:** Announcement of first-round shortlisted teams

• **November 15, 2025:** Submission of interim reports by shortlisted teams

• **December 15, 2025:** Top 50 teams receive funding and cloud resources

• **February 28, 2026:** Final execution & submission deadline

• **March 31, 2026:** Grand finale – awards & project showcase

• **April 1, 2026:** Incubation for the most promising projects

3. Eligibility Criteria

Who can participate?

• Open to individuals, teams, research groups, and startups worldwide.

• Participants must be at least 18 years old.

• Employees of Aion-IA, Apeiria Enterprise Pvt Ltd, or any direct competition partners are not eligible.

• Teams may consist of students, academics, professionals, or independent innovators.

4. Registration & Team Formation

• All participants must register on the official website before **May 31, 2025**.

• A team can have a minimum of **2 members** and a maximum of **6 members**.

• Changes in team composition are allowed until the **first submission deadline (August 15, 2025)**.

5. Competition Rounds & Deliverables

Round 1: Concept Submission

• Teams submit an abstract outlining their quantum-based solution.

• Feasibility, innovation, and impact are evaluated.

Round 2: Prototype & Technical Evaluation

• Teams develop a proof-of-concept or prototype demonstrating their solution.

• Technical feasibility and scalability are assessed.

Final Round: Full-Scale Implementation

• Teams finalize their projects and submit a working prototype or model.

• Live demonstrations and Q&A with judges.

6. Evaluation Criteria

Submissions will be judged based on:

• **Innovation & Uniqueness (30%)** – Novelty of the quantum approach

• **Technical Feasibility (25%)** – Practicality & scientific soundness

• **Impact & Scalability (20%)** – Potential for real-world adoption

• **Execution & Implementation (15%)** – Progress and working model

• **Presentation & Clarity (10%)** – How well the idea is communicated

A distinguished panel of quantum computing experts, academics, and industry leaders will evaluate all submissions.

7. Prize Distribution

The total prize pool is **₹1 Crore INR** (approx. **$120,000 USD**), distributed as follows:

Winning Team: ₹10 Lakhs INR ($12,000)

Runner-Up: ₹5 Lakhs INR ($6,000)

Third Place: ₹2 Lakhs INR (~$2,400)

Top 10 Teams: Each receives ₹1 Lakh INR worth of cloud credits & hardware accessories.

Funding & Resources: ₹50 Lakhs INR allocated for project support, incubation, and R&D.

8. Intellectual Property (IP) Rights

8.1 Ownership

• Participants **retain full ownership** of their IP, research, algorithms, and code.

• However, **Aion-IA & Apeiria Enterprise Pvt Ltd** reserve the right to **showcase and publish** selected works for academic and promotional purposes.

8.2 Commercialization Rights

• **Aion-IA has exclusive first rights to commercialize winning solutions for 3-5 years**.

• If a team develops a patentable solution, they must **notify Aion-IA** before applying for a patent.

• If a winning team forms a startup, **Aion-IA will receive a 5-10% equity share** for providing incubation, funding, and networking support.

9. Funding & Support

• **Top 50 teams** will receive initial funding and resources (up to ₹50 Lakhs INR).

• **Post-competition incubation:** Winning teams may enter Aion-IA's **Quantum Accelerator** for further funding & mentorship.

10. Sponsorship & Partnerships

• Corporate sponsors may provide **grants, hardware, and cloud credits**.

• Winning projects may be **licensed to industry partners** for further development.

11. Compliance & Code of Conduct

• Participants must adhere to the **highest ethical standards** in research and development.

• Plagiarism, falsification of data, or unethical practices will result in **immediate disqualification**.

• Teams must comply with **local and international quantum research regulations**.

12. Post-Competition Opportunities

• **Top teams may be invited** for paid research collaborations with leading quantum labs.

• **Startups formed from this competition** will be eligible for **investment opportunities through Aion-IA's network of VCs and partners**.

• Select teams may be offered **long-term research contracts** with quantum industry leaders.

13. Legal Disclaimer

• Aion-IA and Apeiria Enterprise Pvt Ltd reserve the right to **modify competition terms** as necessary.

• Any disputes arising from the competition will be subject to the jurisdiction of **Indian law**.

14. Acceptance of Terms

By registering for the **Aion-IA Quantum Computing Challenge**, participants agree to abide by these terms and conditions.